

How to Use This Appendix

This appendix adds practice exercises, phrase banks, study plans and reference notes aligned with the main guide. Work through one section per study session and review your notes weekly.

Extended Study Material

The following sections were prepared by Mubashir Mehdi for LifeWithBooks to supplement this guide with additional explanations, examples and practice. Work through them after reading the main chapters.

The Go-To Grammar Reference

Practical English Usage by Michael Swan, published by Oxford University Press, is one of the most widely used grammar and usage references in the English-teaching world. Now in its fourth edition, it covers over 600 points of grammar, vocabulary and pronunciation that cause difficulty for learners of English - and for their teachers.

How the Book Is Organized

Entries are arranged alphabetically for quick reference. Each entry focuses on a specific problem area - from articles and tenses to easily confused words, spelling rules and punctuation. Entries are short, clearly written and packed with natural example sentences that show how the language actually works in practice.

A detailed table of contents and extensive cross-referencing system make it easy to find related topics. If you look up 'wish', for example, cross-references will lead you to related entries on 'if', 'would rather', subjunctive forms and hypothetical past tenses.

Trusted by Teachers Worldwide

The book is used in teacher training programmes, university linguistics courses and translation departments around the world. It strikes a unique balance - linguistically accurate enough for professionals, yet clearly written enough for advanced learners to use independently.

Michael Swan's explanations avoid unnecessary jargon, focus on what learners actually need to know, and address the real mistakes that students make rather than invented textbook errors. The fourth edition has been thoroughly updated with new corpus-based examples and coverage of current usage trends.

Preposition and Grammar Drills

1. I am interested ___ learning English. (in)
2. She arrived ___ Monday morning. (on)
3. We met ___ the airport. (at)
4. He has lived here ___ 2020. (since)
5. The report is ___ the manager's desk. (on)
6. She is good ___ mathematics. (at)

7. Thank you ___ your help. (for)
8. I agree ___ your point. (with)
9. They walked ___ the bridge. (across)
10. We talked ___ the phone for an hour. (on)
11. She is afraid ___ spiders. (of)
12. He apologized ___ being late. (for)
13. This book belongs ___ me. (to)
14. We succeeded ___ finishing on time. (in)
15. She depends ___ public transport. (on)
16. I look forward ___ meeting you. (to)
17. He insisted ___ paying the bill. (on)
18. They laughed ___ the joke. (at)
19. She specializes ___ international law. (in)
20. We waited ___ the bus for twenty minutes. (for)
21. The picture hangs ___ the wall. (on)
22. She is ___ home now. (at)
23. We travel ___ train when possible. (by)
24. He jumped ___ the swimming pool. (into)
25. The cat hid ___ the sofa. (under)
26. She stood ___ me in the queue. (behind)
27. The office is ___ the bank and the library. (between)
28. They discussed the plan ___ detail. (in)
29. I will see you ___ the weekend. (at / on - both common)
30. She has worked here ___ three years. (for)
31. We drove ___ the tunnel. (through)
32. He fell ___ the stairs. (down)
33. The bird flew ___ the roof. (over)
34. She is ___ charge of the project. (in)
35. We agreed ___ a new deadline. (on)
36. He is married ___ a doctor. (to)
37. She complained ___ the noise. (about)
38. I ran ___ an old friend yesterday. (into)
39. They voted ___ the proposal. (for)
40. We need to focus ___ quality first. (on)

Grammar Reference Notes

1. Present simple for habits and facts: She works in IT. Water boils at 100°C.
2. Present continuous for now and temporary situations: I am studying for an exam this week.
3. Past simple for completed past actions: We finished the project yesterday.
4. Past continuous for background actions: It was raining when I left.
5. Present perfect for life experience and recent past with present relevance: I have visited London twice.
6. Present perfect continuous for duration until now: She has been learning English for three years.
7. Future with will for decisions and predictions: I think it will rain tomorrow.
8. Future with going to for plans: We are going to launch the app next month.
9. First conditional for real possibilities: If you study daily, you will improve.
10. Second conditional for hypothetical present: If I had more time, I would travel more.
11. Third conditional for past hypotheticals: If we had left earlier, we would have arrived on time.
12. Modal must for strong obligation: You must wear safety equipment.
13. Modal should for advice: You should review your notes before the test.
14. Modal might for possibility: The meeting might be delayed.

15. Passive voice when agent is unknown or unimportant: The report was approved yesterday.
16. Relative clauses with who/which/that: The engineer who led the team received an award.
17. Reported speech backshift: She said she was tired.
18. Articles: a/an for first mention; the for known items; zero article for general plural nouns.
19. Countable vs uncountable: many ideas / much information.
20. Gerunds after certain verbs: I enjoy reading; He avoided answering.

Extended Reading Passage

Read aloud once for gist, then again for vocabulary. Underline five new words and write your own summary paragraph.

Effective language learning depends on consistent exposure and active use. Many learners spend years studying grammar rules without speaking regularly, which creates a gap between knowledge and performance. Research suggests that daily contact with meaningful input - podcasts, articles, conversations, films with subtitles - builds the mental patterns needed for fluent speech. Output matters too: writing short paragraphs, recording yourself, and joining discussions force your brain to retrieve vocabulary under time pressure, which strengthens long-term memory.

Another key factor is error tolerance. Advanced speakers make mistakes; the goal is communication, not perfection. Keep a personal error log: note recurring problems (prepositions, articles, word order) and review them weekly. Pair study with real tasks - emails, presentations, travel - so new language serves a purpose. Finally, set measurable goals: learn twenty collocations this month, hold a ten-minute conversation twice a week, or finish one graded reader. Small, steady progress beats occasional marathon sessions.

Error Correction Exercises

Find and fix the mistake in each sentence. Answers are in parentheses.

1. She don't like spicy food. (doesn't)
2. I have been to Paris last year. (went - specific past time)
3. He is more taller than his brother. (taller - remove more)
4. We discussed about the problem. (discussed the - no about)
5. She suggested me to apply. (suggested that I apply)
6. I am agree with you. (I agree)
7. He explained me the rules. (explained the rules to me)
8. The informations are useful. (information - uncountable)
9. I look forward to meet you. (to meeting)
10. She is married with a lawyer. (married to)
11. I have a news for you. (some news - uncountable)
12. He did a mistake. (made a mistake)
13. We must to finish today. (must finish)
14. She is boring of the lecture. (bored by / bored with)
15. I am here since three hours. (have been here for)
16. He said that he will come. (would come - reported speech)
17. The children is playing outside. (children are)
18. I am used to wake up early. (used to waking up)
19. She is responsible of the team. (responsible for)
20. We need discuss this later. (need to discuss)

Sentence Building Practice

Combine the prompts into full sentences. Example: [weather / bad / stay home]

-> Because the weather was bad, we decided to stay home.

1. [deadline / tight / work / weekend]
2. [not familiar / software / ask / colleague]
3. [train / delayed / arrive / late]
4. [research / shows / exercise / improves / memory]
5. [although / tired / finish / assignment]
6. [if / more time / learn / second language]
7. [manager / praised / team / hard work]
8. [before / presentation / rehearse / twice]
9. [customer / complained / slow / service]
10. [since / moved / city / made / friends]
11. [unless / study / regularly / forget / vocabulary]
12. [despite / rain / match / continued]
13. [recommend / book / anyone / interested / history]
14. [while / waiting / bus / read / article]
15. [as soon as / hear / news / call / me]

Four-Week Study Plan

Use this plan to study Practical English Usage in daily 30-45 minute sessions.

Week 1 - Foundations

Days 1-2: Skim the guide and list unknown words. Days 3-4: Study one core chapter and summarize it in your own words. Days 5-7: Do practice exercises aloud; record yourself if possible.

Week 2 - Active Practice

Days 8-10: Focus on your weakest section; redo examples without looking. Days 11-12: Explain the material to a friend or aloud alone. Days 13-14: Mixed review from all sections.

Week 3 - Real Usage

Days 15-17: Use new language in real tasks. Days 18-19: Read or listen to authentic English on the same topic. Days 20-21: Write 300 words applying what you learned.

Week 4 - Consolidation

Days 22-24: Timed practice under exam or workplace conditions. Days 25-26: Fix weak areas using notes and answer keys. Days 27-28: Final review before moving to advanced material.

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